

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Dual Boot Woes

Q My PC runs two OSes - Windows ME on the C drive and XP SP2 on the D drive. I'd like to change the time for which you can select the default OS or the other one. With my OS combination, I'm not able to find boot.ini. Is there a software to change the setting?

Patel Kinjesh, via e-mail

A To access boot.ini, you need to boot into Windows XP. Go to Start > Run, type in "%systemdrive%\boot.ini" without the quotes, and press [Enter]. The boot.ini file will open in Notepad. You can now edit it; but be aware that messing up with system files such as boot.ini without knowing exactly what you're doing might cause the computer to not boot at all.

Memory Problems

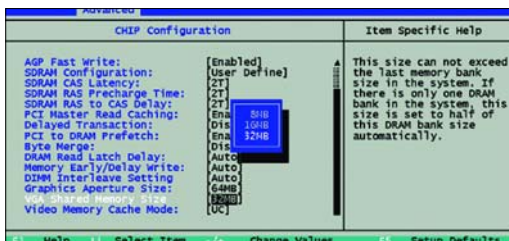
Q I have an Intel Pentium IV 1.70 GHz with 256 MB of RAM and Windows XP Professional SP2. I have the following problems in my system:

- (a) When I add an additional 128 MB of RAM, it becomes $128 + 256 = 384$, but the system keeps restarting.
- (b) I have only 8 MB share of VGA. How can I increase it?

Vibhav V H, via e-mail

A As far as your first problem is concerned, the newer RAM module you installed does not match with the older RAM module, so the system keeps on rebooting. You'll have to get the newer RAM module replaced by a module that is compatible with the older module.

Since you have not mentioned whether you are using onboard graphics or a separate AGP card, we'll provide you with solutions for both alternatives. If you are using onboard graphics, you may be able to increase the shared memory



Set VGA shared memory size in the BIOS

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size of the onboard VGA in the BIOS. Enter the BIOS, and go to 'Integrated Peripherals'. Here you'll be able to modify the amount of memory shared by your onboard VGA. Again, this depends on the motherboard and BIOS version, so it may or may not be present in your case.

If you're using a separate AGP card, there is no way of increasing the share memory, since AGP cards have dedicated onboard memory. You may be able to increase the AGP aperture size using the CMOS setup (by going to 'Integrated Peripherals'.) In either of these cases, since you have only 128 MB of system RAM, avoid setting the shared memory or AGP aperture size to more than 32 MB, as this will degrade your system performance.

Noisy PC

Q I have a Pentium IV 3.0 GHz with HT, an 80 GB ATA Seagate hard drive, and 512 MB of DDR2 RAM on an Intel 915GAV motherboard. Whenever I open a game, my processor's fan speed increases, and is very noisy. What should I do? Also, my retailer told me that I can't install Windows 98 on my system. Is that true?

Ankit Mathur, via e-mail

A The new generation of Intel processors heat up too quickly - especially on load - and need a high-rpm fan. However, since a higher-rpm fan makes more noise, Intel introduced a smart fan that throttles the fan rpm as per the need. When you're gaming, the processor is under high load, so the fan spins at its maximum rpm and could be noisy. One way of controlling the noise is proper ventilation of the cabinet near the processor area so the temperature is maintained, and so the fan won't throttle to higher speeds.

The Intel 915GAV chipset does not support Windows 9x/ME, and you will not be able to install these OSes on motherboards based on this chipset.

I want it Back!

Q I have a 40 GB Seagate hard disk. I installed Red Hat Linux on one partition that Linux created during the installation. After a few days, I decided to remove Linux. When I started fdisk, it said my hard disk had only 30 GB, with the 10 GB Linux partition not showing up. I later installed Windows 98 SE (on the 30 GB partition). Then I used Seagate Disk Manager (DM), but DM shows the error "BIOS.ovl file couldn't open". How do I reclaim the full 40 GB capacity of my hard disk?

Vikram Dan, via e-mail

A You should be able to reclaim the full 40 GB using Seagate's Disk Manager. If you do not have the latest version of the Disc Wizard Starter Edition (DWSE), download it from the Seagate Web site. Run the downloaded file to create the DWSE disks - you'll need two floppies for this. When the bootable DWSE disk is created, you will be able to boot with the floppy, and the Disk Manager will start. From here, you will be able to